



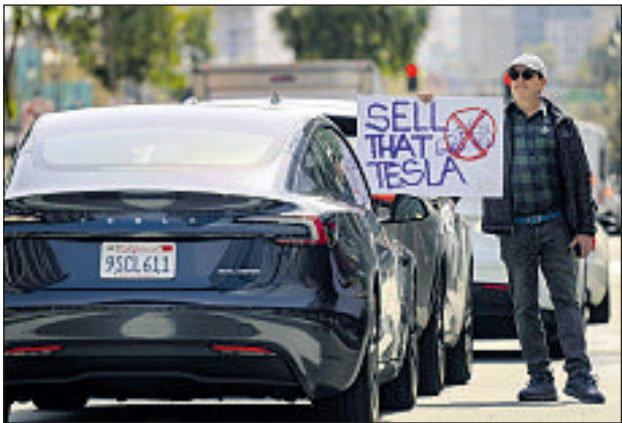
A SEATTLE Fire Department official inspects a burned Tesla Cybertruck after four were set ablaze on March 9. Similar incidents across the U.S. included defacement, tire slashing and damage to dealerships.

Tesla attacks mark alarming twist in political violence

Once the darling of alternative energy advocates, the electric vehicles are now targeted because of their connection to Musk

By RICHARD WINTON
AND HANNAH FRY

There were broad expectations that the widening political divides in America following Donald Trump's second presidential victory would explode. But few could have predicted the focal point would be electric cars. Teslas have been set ablaze with Molotov cocktails, riddled with bullets and defaced with swastikas. Doors and windows at once-pristine luxury electric vehicle showrooms are now



THERE also have been peaceful protests against Tesla. Above, a man at a San Francisco rally.

scrawled with profanity and Nazi symbols. Teslas, once the darling of alternative energy advocates, are now the unlikely target of political violence. Experts say while the singling out of individual vehicles is unusual, activists focusing ire on a corporation has a long history in America. No one has been seriously hurt in the incidents, but they have heightened alarm from both law enforcement officials and experts in political extremism about where this is heading.

A Trump ally in state aims to rein in judges

Rep. Darrell Issa has introduced a measure as president targets the authority of jurists on federal benches.

By FAITH E. PINHO
AND JAMES QUEALLY

WASHINGTON — As court orders against his administration mount, President Trump has ramped up his attacks on federal judges in recent days, railing against their authority and calling for their impeachment. In particular, the president seems to have zeroed in on the idea of limiting federal district judges' ability to issue injunctions that have national implications. "Unlawful Nationwide Injunctions by Radical Left Judges could very well lead to the destruction of our Country!" Trump posted Thursday night on his social media platform. "These people are Lunatics, who do not care, even a little bit, about the repercussions from their very dangerous and incorrect Decisions and Rulings." While Trump rages on social media — going as far as calling on the U.S. Supreme Court to limit district courts' ability to grant injunctions — one California Republican in Congress is working to rein in the judges who are checking Trump's powers. Rep. Darrell Issa of Bon-sall introduced the No Rogue Rulings Act, or NORRA, last month to limit federal judges' ability to issue nationwide injunctions, curtailing their ability to make decisions that affect people outside their district. Issa's legislation has gained traction among several prominent Republicans — including the president,

who is determined to advance his anti-immigration agenda despite setbacks in the courts. "You can't stop that with a judge sitting behind a bench who has no idea what's going on, who happens to be a radical left lunatic," Trump said Friday from the Oval Office. In Washington, where Republicans control the White House, Senate and House of Representatives. Issa's bill reflects a broader push by Republicans to clamp down on the judiciary. [See Issa, A7]

Council moves to curb slurs at meetings

L.A.'s proposal calls for removing those in the audience who use two offensive words.

By DAVID ZAHNISER

For the last decade, the Los Angeles City Council chamber has been center stage for some of the meanest, most offensive messages delivered in an open government forum. A few speakers routinely hurl racial slurs, antisemitic phrases or other forms of verbal abuse at council members. They have attacked officials' looks, their weight, their clothes, their sexual orientation and their gender, curdling the proceedings on a regular basis. On Friday, seven council members took a first step toward pushing back on such language, signing a proposal to prohibit just two of the words.

Under their proposal, initiated by council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson, audience members could be removed from meetings — or banned from attending future ones — for repeatedly uttering the racial slur known as the N-word or the sexist vulgarity known as the C-word. Harris-Dawson, who is Black, said the frequent use of those words during public comment has put a chill on civic participation, discouraging people from coming to the council's meetings, which take place three times a week. At times, the use of racist words has led to disruptions among audience members, he said. Harris-Dawson said his colleagues may add more prohibited words to the proposal as it is debated over the coming weeks. But he said those two words in particular "have no political value" — and are meant only to insult a person's immutable characteristics. [See City Council, A7]

Kink and rough sex at heart of rape case

Actor Gabriel Olds is facing a life term for what prosecutors say were vicious assaults.

By HARRIET RYAN

The character letters submitted to a Los Angeles judge were not the customary expressions of support, especially for a man accused of rape. "He taught me about a world of intimacy which was beyond my experience," one woman, a physician, wrote of sexual encounters with an actor named Gabriel Olds. "We would incorporate choking and other painful acts, and we frequently videotaped ourselves too," another who dated Olds explained. "He was such a gentle ass slapper[,] I told him he could go harder," a third lover recalled. "It was the best sex I have ever had," a fourth wrote of what she called their "situationship." The testimonials offered in an effort to reduce his bail [See Olds, A12]

FAMILIES SAY DEPORTEES' ONLY CRIME WAS HAVING TATTOOS

They're among hundreds of Venezuelans the U.S. sent to El Salvador

By PATRICK J. McDONNELL, KATE LINTHICUM, MERY MOGOLLON AND NELSON RAUDA

SAN SALVADOR — One is a former professional soccer player who, according to his lawyer, fled Venezuela after being tortured by the country's authoritarian government. The other, also from Venezuela, is a onetime shoe salesman and social media influencer who documented his journey from South America on TikTok. Both were apparently among thousands of political asylum aspirants who entered the United States from Mexico legally via an immigration process scrapped by the Trump administration. Both were detained, one in California, and deported. Now they are imprisoned in El Salvador, according to their families, who have been left in the dark about their fates in a penal system [See Venezuelans, A4]



NOLBERTO Rafael Aguilar Rodríguez got his tattoo of cards and dice to cover a scar from a childhood accident, his sister says. The U.S. called it a gang symbol.

Students weigh in on cellphone ban

One month in, some like the policy; others are resigned. And some get creative. CALIFORNIA, B1

No. 1 UCLA vs. No. 8 Richmond

For coverage of Sunday night's second-round women's game, go to latimes.com/sports.

Angels try to give their fans hope

Team seeks turnaround after years of weak play, columnist Bill Shaikin writes. SPORTS, D1

Weather

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